

SOC101_Introduction to Sociology and Anthropology

Mid Semester Exam Paper

Total Time: 1 hour

Total Marks: 20

Instructions: All questions are compulsory ; Use of any unfair means will invoke penalty

SECTION I : MCQ type (0.25*8= 2)

1. Nokia responded to customer needs with the introduction of a dust-resistant keypad, anti-slip grip and an inbuilt flash light for Indian rural consumers (specifically targeting truck drivers). This is an example of:
- a. Cultural Imperialism
 - b. Globalization
 - c. Cultural Relativism
 - d. Globalization
2. Which of the following concept pair the following latest viral social media post reflects
- a) Stereotyping and Ethnocentrism
 - b) Ethnocentrism and Cultural Relativism
 - c) Stereotyping and Cultural Relativism
 - d) Ethnocentrism and Cultural Imperialism
3. Stem Cell Research has shown stem cells to be the most effective in the treatment and cure of several diseases. However, conservative developing societies often still see the use of stem cells, particularly those from an unborn fetus or a new born baby, to be an ethical issue. These issues arise because of
- a. Unequal effects of globalization with advanced economies being the center of R&D while developing societies being labour intensive economies
 - b. Non-material culture takes time to catch up with scientific developments
 - c. Culture Shock
 - d. Cultural Universals around life-crisis ceremony like birth
4. Which of the following is not a characteristic of culture:
- a. Elements make up a complex whole
 - b. Socially acquired
 - c. Transmitted intergenerationally
 - d. Biologically derived.
5. Which method is strongly associated with empiricism
- a) Critical Reading
 - b) Reflective Thinking
 - c) Polling
 - d) Historicizing
- 6) An example of a *Public Issue* is
- a) Father going through a divorce
 - b) MNC worker losing her job
 - c) High drop-out rates amongst college students
 - d) Child being bullied by his peers

7) Text-to-image AI is already being used in applications from visual communication giants Adobe Inc. and chipmaker Nvidia Corp., and is starting to power the ads we watch. To gauge the magnitude of biases in generative AI, a news media agency Bloomberg used Stable Diffusion (text to image AI) to generate thousands of images related to job titles and crime. Bloomberg researchers prompted the text-to-image model to create representations of workers for 14 jobs — 300 images each for seven jobs that are typically considered “high-paying” in the US and seven that are considered “low-paying” — plus three categories related to crime. The images were then classified on the basis of skin pigmentation (lighter and darker skin) and gender (male, female, unknown). Given the class discussions on how AI, like every technology, is a political in nature and reflects human biases, what do you think are the most likely outcomes of these exercises from the options below

- 1) Women are rare in high paying jobs like doctors, lawyers or judges
- 2) Dark skin males than dark skin females are more likely to be criminal
- 3) Dark and light skin tones were equally represented in high paying jobs

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) All of the above
- d) None of the above

8) Time-space compression is:

- a) Capitalism's insatiable requirement for new spaces for markets and quicker pace for profits through economic activity at global scale
- b) A shared ecology involving quick responses to environmental problems of globalisation (global warming to species protection), alongside the creation of multilateral responses in various regions and countries as per local environmental governance norms
- c) The technologically induced erosion of spatiality and temporality, giving the appearance of a world that is shrinking.
- d) An idea central to any account of cultural imperialism since it is rapidly expanding in sense of time and spatially extending to all economies across the world

Section-II

One word Answers (0.25*8=2)

1. For each, name who coined the following Concepts or proposed these ideas

- a) Social Fact b) Time-space Compression c) Sociological Imagination
- d) Cultural Lag e) Social Statics f) Species Being
- g) Dare to know h) Servants of Globalisation

Section -III Short answer questions (2*3=6)

- Differentiate between Ethnocentrism and Cultural Relativism. Illustrate with one concrete example (not used in class/reading) how these concepts can be helpful for engineers in thinking about technological solutions for any kind of population grouping.
- Define what is Sociological Imagination. Provide an example of how to apply it.
- What are the three main reasons for the rise of global culture and what are its critiques?

SECTION IV Long Answer type (10*1=10)

- The assembly in the state of Rajasthan passed the Right to Health Bill in 2022. The Right to Health Bill, gives every resident of the state the right to avail free services at all public health facilities. It's Key Features are: a) Free healthcare services, including consultation, drugs, diagnostics, emergency transport, procedure and emergency care, will be provided at all public health institutions and select private facilities subject to conditions specified in the rules. b) It is mandatory for the hospitals to provide treatment in emergency cases without waiting for medico-legal formalities and give medicines and transport facilities without charging money. c) The implementation of the law is expected to do away with out-of-pocket expenditure and bring transparency and accountability within the health care system.

However, several doctors and medical residents took to the streets to protest against this bill as evidenced in the images below



As a social science researcher, if you were to study this social event, (a) Explain what are the various epistemological perspectives available to you? (b) Explain how you will apply these epistemological perspectives to research this problem and what kind of knowledge will be generated using each of the perspectives?